

Harvey Prompt Library Use

Step-by-Step Guide: Using Harvey Vault for legal education tasks.



The Prompt Library should be treated as a curated prompt development space: select, preview, localise, test, verify, restrict where necessary, and document what changed. The aim is not to encourage “prompt shopping”, but to build a governed collection of prompts that support legal method, source checking, educator judgement, and responsible student use.

Use the Prompt Library as a starting point, not as a finished curriculum resource. Prompts should be selected, checked, localised, tested, and revised before they are used with students or embedded in teaching workflows. The meeting recap notes that the Harvey Library contains pre-prepared prompts for faculty, students, and clinics, but that much of the existing content is US-focused and should be adapted for Australian legal education contexts.

Finding Prompts

Step	Action	What to do	Output
1	Open the Library	In Harvey, go to the Library area. This is where pre-prepared prompts and reusable prompt assets are located.	Access to the available prompt collection.
2	Identify your purpose first	Decide what you want the prompt to support: case preparation, seminar questions, issue spotting, source checking, assessment design, feedback drafting, or student practice. Do this before browsing.	A defined teaching or workflow purpose.
3	Filter or browse by audience	Look for prompts relevant to the intended user group: faculty, students, or clinic users. The recap notes that the library includes prompts for different audiences and that student/faculty visibility may need local control.	A shortlist of potentially relevant prompts.

Checking Prompts

Step	Action	What to do	Output
1	Preview the prompt	Open the prompt preview before using it. Read the instructions, assumed jurisdiction, intended task, output format, and any hidden assumptions.	A first quality check.
2	Check jurisdictional fit	Identify whether the prompt assumes US law, US legal education, US procedure, or US professional norms. Replace these with the relevant Australian, NSW, Commonwealth, or unit-specific context.	A locally appropriate version.
3	Check the audience	Confirm whether the prompt is suitable for educators, students, clinic supervisors, or professional staff. A faculty-oriented prompt may be inappropriate for student-facing use.	Correct audience alignment.
4	Check the task boundary	Reject or revise prompts that ask for final legal advice, a complete model answer, unsourced doctrinal claims, or a jurisdiction-free explanation. The safer pattern is to ask for structure, issues, questions, comparison points, or draft language for review.	A bounded prompt.

Localisation

Step	Action	What to do	Output
1	Add local teaching context	Insert the unit, cohort, level, jurisdiction, legal topic, task purpose, and any source limits. Prompt design should specify jurisdiction, role, task, facts, audience, constraints, and output format.	A contextualised prompt.

Verification, Testing and Iteration

Step	Action	What to do	Output
1	Add verification instructions	Require Harvey to flag uncertainty, avoid invented authorities, identify source assumptions, and state what needs human checking. Verification should be built into meaningful use rather than added afterwards.	A more reviewable output.

2	Test the prompt privately	Run the adapted prompt yourself before sharing it. Check whether the output is accurate, useful, appropriately scoped, and suitable for the intended student cohort.	A tested draft prompt.
3	Revise the prompt	Tighten vague wording. Replace “discuss” with defined output requirements such as “produce a table”, “generate five seminar questions”, or “identify three issues without answering the problem”. A usable prompt should tell Harvey what to produce, what not to do, the legal context, the audience, and the level of detail required.	A refined prompt.

Access

Step	Action	What to do	Output
1	Decide whether it is faculty-only or student-facing	Determine whether the prompt should remain for staff use only, be adapted for students, or be withheld. The meeting recap notes concern about students seeing faculty-oriented prompts and the need for access controls.	A visibility decision.
2	Apply access controls where required	Work with the relevant Harvey/admin/IT process to hide, restrict, or share prompts with the correct group. The recap notes that prompts can be hidden by admins, though more granular filtering may require further work with IT.	Controlled access.
3	Prevent unregulated student contribution	Do not allow students to create or contribute to the main prompt library unless this has been explicitly approved through the local governance process. The recap records that students should not contribute to the main library in order to maintain regulation.	Protected library governance.

Save

Step	Action	What to do	Output
1	Save, share, or recommend the prompt	Once checked, save the adapted prompt in the appropriate place, share it with the relevant staff group, or recommend it for inclusion in a curated faculty/student collection.	A reusable local prompt asset.

2	Document what changed	Keep a short note explaining the original prompt source, what was changed, why it was changed, what was tested, and what still requires verification. Disclosure and accountability are part of responsible Harvey use.	A short audit note.
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Suggested workflow for adapting a Library prompt

Stage	Question to ask	Decision
Purpose	What teaching or workflow problem does this prompt address?	Keep only if there is a defined use.
Audience	Is this for faculty, students, clinics, or professional staff?	Revise or restrict if the audience is wrong.
Jurisdiction	Does it assume US law or another non-local frame?	Localise before use.
Task type	Does it ask for support, structure, extraction, comparison, or a final answer?	Prefer support tasks over substitute outputs.
Verification	Does it require sources, uncertainty flags, and checking?	Add verification requirements.
Risk	Could students misuse it to bypass learning or produce a complete answer?	Restrict, revise, or do not use.
Governance	Should this be visible to students?	Apply access controls.

Prompt Library readiness checklist

Before saving or sharing a prompt, check:

Check	Ready when...
Context is explicit	The prompt names the unit, cohort, jurisdiction, and area of law.
Task is bounded	It asks for a reviewable support output, not a complete legal answer.
Output format is specified	It states whether the output should be a table, list, questions, issue headings, checklist, or short draft.
Limits are stated	It tells Harvey not to invent authorities, not to exceed the requested scope, and to flag uncertainty.
Verification is required	It tells the user what must be checked against primary or reliable legal sources.
Audience is correct	Faculty-only prompts are not visible to students unless deliberately adapted.

Localisation is complete	US or generic assumptions have been replaced with Australian, NSW, Commonwealth, institutional, or unit-specific framing.
Human review remains visible	The educator remains responsible for checking accuracy, source grounding, and pedagogical suitability.

Example: adapting a generic Library prompt

Generic version	Better localised version
“Summarise this case for a law class.”	“Using Australian legal education conventions, produce a concise teaching summary of [case name] for later-year LLB students in [unit name] . Use the following headings: procedural posture, material facts, legal issue, holding, reasoning, key authority, and one discussion question. Do not invent authorities. Flag any uncertainty and identify what must be checked against the judgment.”
“Create discussion questions about contract law.”	“Draft five seminar discussion questions for Australian Contracts students on consideration and reliance . The questions should move from recall to application and evaluation. Do not provide model answers. Identify one likely misconception and one source students should check.”
“Help mark this student answer.”	“Using the supplied rubric only, identify where the anonymised student response appears to address each criterion. Do not assign a final mark. Provide evidence-based comments for educator review and flag any judgement that requires human moderation.”

Recommended local categories for the Prompt Library

Category	Use case	Example prompt type
Teaching preparation	Preparing seminars, lectures, worked examples, or revision activities.	Generate discussion questions; create issue headings; draft activity instructions.
Legal method support	Helping students practise disciplined legal reasoning.	Identify issues without answering; classify authorities; compare reasoning.
Verification and source checking	Making authority checking visible.	Create a source-checking table; classify claims as supported, incomplete, misleading, or unsupported.
Assessment design	Supporting educators with criteria, feedback structures, and sample outlines.	Draft grade-band descriptors; create moderation checklists.

Feedback drafting	Supporting educator-led feedback and feed-forward.	Map anonymised submission features to rubric criteria; draft comments for review.
Professional responsibility	Teaching appropriate AI use boundaries.	Create privacy, confidentiality, disclosure, or escalation scenarios.
Student-facing practice	Safe, bounded classroom or tutorial use.	Prompt refinement sprint; authority audit; disclosure note.

Model instruction to attach to student-facing prompts

Use this prompt for learning support only. Do not treat the output as legal authority or as a complete answer. Check every legal proposition, case reference, statutory reference, and quotation against approved sources. You remain responsible for the final work, including what you accept, reject, revise, and disclose.



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